EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 2 NOVEMBER 2026

Schöneberg, Berlin

Berlin's El Niño heat deaths happened in summer 2026. This winter the danger is cold and long blackouts, and next summer it is heat again, so Schöneberg needs one list, built now, of who lives alone, who is bedridden, and who depends on a machine.

REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Berlin (GADM DEU.3_1), state level	58 already past (June–September 2026); 2 forecast October 2026 – March 2027	6-month forecast, Oct 2026 – Mar 2027; summer 2027 is not covered	Summer heat in top-floor flats; this winter, cold for people sleeping rough and multi-day blackouts; summer cloudbursts

24/24 recommendations checked. 5 confirmed, 19 corrected, 0 unverified, 0 contraindicated among the recommendations that remain. That covers the 9 ranked actions (9 corrected), the 6 "Do not do this" cards (2 confirmed, 4 corrected), and the 9 For you steps (3 confirmed, 6 corrected). Four proposals were dropped: rewriting the rules of Berlin's energy-debt hardship fund (it closed on 31 December 2025, so it is now a "Do not" card), pre-funding food-bank points (could not be verified), stockpiling coffee and cocoa (any price rise is 6–9 months away), and a donor-paid heat coordinator (a civil-service post). Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review. It is published for the state of Berlin, not for

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



52.48°N 13.35°E, Germany · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Berlin's heat deaths range from 26 to 425 a year; this winter's danger is cold for people sleeping rough, and blackouts for people on home machines.
- **For you.** Today, save 112 and the Kältebus (030 690 333 690), and install the NINA or WarnWetter app. It costs nothing.
- **The money.** €58,000–115,400 (US$65,053–129,433); doorstep checks on heat-warning days are where the first euros go.
- **Do not.** Do not tell an older person a fan will keep them safe: at 36 °C, in a 2024 trial, it did not lower their body temperature.*

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Schöneberg, and counts heat only. 58 of Berlin's 60 projected deaths fell in June–September 2026, so this briefing plans for this winter and for summer 2027, which the tracker does not cover. Almost nothing in it depends on El Niño. After verification, the funding target fell from €185,400 (US$207,945) to €90,400 (US$101,393), down 51%, because a salaried post was removed and a cost per death averted was retracted. The Climate Impact Lab Adaptation Inventory returned no entries to the research agents, so no precedent could be confirmed there.

FOR YOU, AS A RESIDENT — 9 STEPS

In Schöneberg the people at risk are mostly very old, living alone, bedridden, or on a machine at home: in a cold flat during a four-day blackout, or under the roof in July. Most of what protects them costs nothing and has to be set up in winter and spring. The ranked actions below are written for the district and its partners. These are the ones you can take yourself.

Save the numbers and turn on warnings today: 112, the Kältebus, and the NINA or WarnWetter app

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 2

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
today	none	the household, and people sleeping rough nearby

For someone sleeping rough in the cold, call the Berliner Stadtmission Kältebus on 030 690 333 690 (November–March, 20:00–02:00), the DRK Wärmebus on 030 600 300 1010 (November–March, 18:00–24:00), or the Kältehilfetelefon on 030 34 39 71 40 (October–April, 19:00–23:00), which knows where beds are free. If the person does not respond, call 112. The free NINA app (federal warnings, blackouts) and the DWD WarnWetter app (frost and heat warnings, down to your district) cover the household. The Kältehilfe app's free-bed display is still being rolled out; older lists carry outdated numbers, so use these.*

Keep ten days of food, water, and medicines, and a battery or crank radio, by 30 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ROLE-SPECIFIC

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

BY WHEN
30 November 2026

COST TO YOU
depends on what you have; no price is published

PROTECTS
everyone at home in a blackout

The federal civil-protection office (BBK) advises aiming for ten days on your own, with two litres of water per person per day and at least ten days of any regular medicine; even three days helps. In January 2026 arson cut power and heating to 45,400 households in south-west Berlin, next to Schöneberg, for about four and a half days in frost; emergency calls were hard to make for much of that time.*

If anyone at home uses electric medical equipment, agree a plan for a three-to-five-day outage with the care service or supplier, by 15 December

CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 1

BY WHEN
15 December 2026

COST TO YOU
none to ask

PROTECTS
people on home ventilation, oxygen, or dialysis

Nobody in Berlin keeps a list of people who depend on electricity at home: the Senate told parliament in 2026 that such people "are not subject to any mandatory registration," and they could not be found during the January blackout. Ask about battery runtime, spare oxygen, and where to go. Stromnetz Berlin's 24-hour fault line is 0800 211 2525. Berlin's new emergency register (§ 5a of the state disaster law, in force since July 2026) is voluntary; when it opens, put yourself or your relative on it.*

If a letter threatens to cut off your electricity or gas, call the Verbraucherzentrale energy-debt advice within days

CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 7

BY WHEN
as soon as the letter arrives

COST TO YOU
none; the advice is free

PROTECTS
heat and light at home this winter

Call 030 21485-202 (Monday–Thursday 10:00–16:00, Friday 10:00–14:00). The supplier must warn you four weeks ahead, give you the cut-off date eight working days before, offer a payment plan, and may not cut you off where that would put life or health at concrete risk. In 2024 the advice service reversed 54 of 83 cut-offs that had already happened. Do not apply to the Härtefallfonds Energieschulden: it closed on 31 December 2025.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

If you may qualify for Wohngeld, make sure your application reaches the Wohngeldstelle by 31 December

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 8

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
received by 31 December 2026	none	household income, especially for pensioners

A federal bill, still before parliament, would halve Wohngeld's heating component from 1 January 2027 and skip the 2027 increase. Under the draft, an application received by 31 December 2026 keeps the current amount for its whole approval period; a renewal whose new period starts on 1 January does not. Tempelhof-Schöneberg takes 8–11 weeks to decide, but the date the application arrives is what counts. The bill could still change.

Ask your GP or pharmacist, by 31 May, whether any medicine you or an older relative takes raises the risk in heat

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ROLE-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
31 May 2027	none	older people and anyone on regular medication

Water tablets (diuretics), blood-pressure drugs, and some psychiatric and anticholinergic medicines change how the body handles heat; the pharmacists' federation (ABDA) and Heidelberg University Hospital publish lists. Psychiatric illness roughly triples the odds of dying in a heatwave. Ask what to change on hot days rather than stopping anything yourself.*

Name two neighbours who are very old, bedridden, or sleep under the roof, and check on them in person every heat-warning day

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 3

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
agreed by June 2027	none	your neighbours

In France in 2003, older people confined to bed had 9.6 times the odds of dying at home, and those whose bedroom was under the roof 4.1 times. A knock at the door from someone they know reaches people no flyer does. An older person can also call Silbernetz

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

themselves (0800 4 70 80 90, daily 8:00–22:00, free), and can ask Silbernetz on 030 544 533 0 533 whether its free heat-warning calls, funded by the Lotto-Stiftung, now cover Schöneberg. You cannot enrol someone else. To volunteer, call Silbernetz on 030 5445330-24.

Keep the flat cool without relying on a fan, and know your nearest cool room

CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 4

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
from June 2027	none	everyone at home, above all on the top floor

Close blinds and shutters by day, ventilate at night, take cool showers, and wet the skin. In summer 2026 the district's cool rooms (Kühle Räume) included the VHS at Barbarossaplatz 5 (Monday–Friday 10:00–16:00), the Apostel-Paulus-Kirche at Grunewaldstraße 77A (daily 12:00–18:00), the Stadtteilzentrum at Hauptstraße 121A (Monday, Wednesday, Thursday 10:00–15:00; Tuesday 13:00–15:00), and HUZUR at Bülowstraße 94 (Monday–Wednesday 9:00–16:00, closed in August). Check kuehle-orte.berlin.de in June, because the list changes.*

If you live in a basement or ground-floor flat, ask the landlord by May whether the building has backflow protection

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ROLE-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
31 May 2027	none to ask	your home and belongings in a cloudburst

On 29 June 2017 Tegel recorded 196.9 mm of rain in a day and the fire brigade declared a state of emergency. Berliner Wasserbetriebe says fitting a backflow valve (Rückstausicherung) is the owner's duty, and that building insurance does not pay for backflow damage when none is fitted. Check separately whether your own contents insurance (Hausrat) includes natural-hazard (Elementar) cover; most Berlin buildings are not covered.

What to ask of the people in charge

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- Ask the Bezirksamt Tempelhof-Schöneberg (its health planning office, QPK) whether it will build a consent-based list of people on home machines and bedridden people before the winter, rather than wait for the Senate's register (action 1).
- Ask the Senate's social department (SenASGIVA) what will trigger extra Kältehilfe places this winter, and whether some will take dogs and couples (action 2).
- Ask the Bezirksamt when the heat coordinator post will be advertised, and whether HUZUR's cool room can open in August 2027 (action 4).

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO — RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort, first before the winter cold, then before the first heatwaves of summer 2027. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet. Several of the district facts come from the whole Bezirk Tempelhof-Schöneberg (about 350,000 people), not the Ortsteil Schöneberg alone.

1. Build one consent-based list of people on home machines and bedridden people by 15 December, and use it for blackouts this winter and heat next summer

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bezirksamt Tempelhof-Schöneberg (QPK and its disaster-protection officer), through the care services	**pilot list by 15 Dec 2026; heat consent by 31 May 2027**	**staff time; not costed**	**deaths of people nobody knew to check on, in a blackout or a heatwave**

After the January 2026 blackout, the neighbouring district's own review found "no reliable information" on who depended on ventilation, dialysis, or other technology. Of 2,760 people over 85 in the affected area, the Ordnungsamt visited about 60, and only when relatives asked. Berlin now has a legal basis: § 5a of the state disaster law (in force 23 July 2026) creates a voluntary emergency register for people who need special help, and care providers must cooperate unless the person objects. But the Senate has not yet named who keeps it, and the law allows its use only in a major incident or disaster. So the district should start a small list now, with each person's explicit written consent (GDPR Article 9) and data agreements with each care service, feed it into the register when that opens, and ask separately for consent to use it for heat calls. People over 85 who live alone fall outside § 5a and need their own consent.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: good. The failure it fixes happened next door, last winter. France has kept municipal registers of vulnerable people since 2004. The 15 December date is realistic only for a small pilot.

2. This winter, run Kältehilfe at full capacity all season, add about 100 surge places when occupancy passes 90% or DWD warns of severe frost, and put them where people sleep rough

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · ECONOMIST · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC · PUBLIC HEALTH · FRONTLINE

ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
SenASGIVA, with the Kältehilfe providers (Berliner Stadtmission, IB, DRK)	contracts by 1 Dec 2026; surge December–March	€90,000 (US$100,944) for 100 places over 30 nights, at the Senate's average cost of about €30 (US$34) a place-night	cold deaths among people sleeping rough when the beds are full

Last winter Berlin's emergency shelter grew from about 670 places to 1,280 in the January frost, when temperatures fell to −15 °C, and occupancy peaked at about 96%. The season cost €4.9 million (US$5.5 million). Schöneberg's two Kältehilfe sites, the IB shelter on Kurmärkische Straße (30 places) and the Goßlerstraße night café in Friedenau (four nights a week), were both full. Location matters: in January the ad-hoc places in Steglitz ran 10–27% full while the Stadtmission at Zoo and the Bahnhofsmission ran at 64–100%. Some surge places need lockers and room for dogs and couples (see "Do not do this"), with Kältebus outreach on frost nights around Nollendorfplatz, Bülowstraße, and Kurfürstenstraße.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the surge model is Berlin's own. No study gives an effect size for shelters or outreach on cold deaths, so this rests on documented need rather than measured effect. In Toronto, 72% of hypothermia cases happened above −15 °C, which is why the trigger is occupancy as well as frost.

3. On every DWD heat-warning day from June to September 2027, call everyone on the list and visit anyone who does not answer, and log every contact

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC · EMERGENCY MANAGER | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bezirksamt (QPK), with Nachbarschaftsheim Schöneberg's visiting service and volunteers	callers trained by 31 May 2027; live from the first warning	€25,000 (US$28,040) for a part-time organiser and volunteer training, an estimate	indoor deaths of very old, isolated, and bedridden people

In a pooled analysis of six case-control studies (Bouchama 2007), being confined to bed raised the odds of dying in a heatwave 6.4-fold, and more social contact cut them to 0.40. In one Rome district, a Sant'Egidio programme of calls and visits to people over 80 was associated with summer deaths rising 48.8% against 97.3% elsewhere (Liotta 2018; observational, one summer, run by the programme's own staff). Nachbarschaftsheim Schöneberg has about 1,000 staff, 1,574 volunteers, its own care station, and a visiting service. Silbernetz cannot simply be handed the list, because its calls are for people who enrol themselves, so this needs its own callers. The logs give the district its first real evaluation of its heat plan.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: good. The evidence is European and urban, but observational. With about three heat deaths in a typical Schöneberg summer and a dozen in a bad one (our scaling from Berlin's counts), deaths will never show whether this worked, so judge it by how many people on the list were reached.

4. Keep the cool rooms open and reachable in summer 2027, with escorts for people who cannot walk there, and keep the Hitzehilfe on Kurmärkische Straße funded

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MANAGER · ECONOMIST · HISTORIAN · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bezirksamt Tempelhof-Schöneberg, with SenASGIVA for the Hitzehilfe	coordinator post advertised and Hitzehilfe confirmed by 31 Mar 2027	€32,400 (US$36,340) to staff two more rooms (90 days × 6 hours × 2 rooms × €30), an estimate; Hitzehilfe €85,412 (US$95,798), already budgeted	heat illness among people with no cool place, including homeless people

Visiting cool places cut the odds of heat death to 0.34 in the same pooled analysis. The district's 2026 heat plan names two cool rooms; its web page lists about eight, some with short hours, and HUZUR, where Turkish-speaking older people meet, is closed in August. The plan says the €100,000 (US$112,160) a year the Senate gave each district in 2024 and 2025 is "no longer available" in 2026, and that advertising the heat coordinator post "continues to be delayed." For homeless people, SenASGIVA asked parliament's budget committee in May 2026 to release €85,412 for each of 2026 and 2027 to keep the IB Hitzehilfe day shelter on Kurmärkische Straße open June–August, as a central contact point for homeless sex workers. Whether it was released is not confirmed.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the cool-room evidence comes from US and French case-control studies. Cool rooms do not reach bedridden people, which is why action 3 comes first.

5. Before 31 December, tell every household in Schöneberg where to go in a blackout: the emergency hub at Rathaus Schöneberg, plus named churches and neighbourhood centres

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bezirksamt Tempelhof-Schöneberg (civil protection)	31 December 2026	€5,000 (US$5,608) for leaflets and a multilingual card, an estimate	people sitting in cold, dark flats because they do not know where help is

The district has three Katastrophenschutz-Leuchttürme (emergency hubs that open only when a crisis is announced), at Rathaus Schöneberg, Rathaus Tempelhof, and the Gemeinschaftshaus Lichtenrade; in February 2026 the Rathaus Schöneberg one was still being brought into operation. None of the smaller official information points has been designated in Schöneberg. The neighbouring district's review recommends exactly this: bring in churches and neighbourhood centres, and make sure people know the sites in advance, because loudspeaker announcements did not work. Leaflets go through property managers; a pocket card in German, Turkish, Arabic, Polish, Bulgarian, and Romanian lists the hub, 112, and, labelled as help for homeless people, the Kältebus, Wärmebus, and Kältehilfetelefon with their hours.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: good; it fixes a failure recorded in Berlin in January 2026. Confirm that the Rathaus Schöneberg hub is ready before printing.

6. Offer heat training to the district's remaining 55 or so home-care services by 31 May 2027

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · PHILANTHROPIST · EMERGENCY MANAGER · PUBLIC HEALTH · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bezirksamt (QPK), through Bär meets Adler e.V.	31 May 2027	€33,000 (US$37,013), at an estimated €600 a service; no price is published	carers missing the signs of heat illness in the flats they visit daily

The QPK commissioned Bär meets Adler e.V. to reach all of the district's roughly 70 ambulatory care services; 15 took the training, plus the Berliner Hausbesuche guides. These carers already enter the hottest flats of the most dependent people every day.

Transferability and evidence: weak. No study links care-staff heat training to fewer deaths; the national training package was evaluated only on how participants rated it, and the district plan itself says the effect is "hard to measure." Low uptake (15 of 70) suggests the services' willingness, not the trainer, is the limit.

7. Send every household that gets a cut-off threat to the free Verbraucherzentrale energy-debt advice, and to Jobcenter or Sozialamt loans

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ECONOMIST · FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bezirksamt social services and advice centres, with Verbraucherzentrale Berlin	from now through March 2027	none new	households losing heat and light in winter

Energy prices, not El Niño, are what is hurting households here: in October 2026 German energy prices were 12.2% higher than a year earlier, and heating oil 74.9% higher in September, while food was up only 0.4%. Berlin's hardship fund for energy debts closed on 31 December 2025, after approving 2 of 195 applications in 2025 (0 of 11 in Tempelhof-Schöneberg) and paying €945 (US$1,060) in total.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

What works is advice: in 2024 the Verbraucherzentrale's service reversed 54 of 83 cut-offs. Federal energy law requires four weeks' warning and forbids a cut-off where life or health is at concrete risk; Jobcenters can cover energy debts, usually as a loan.

Transferability: this is Berlin's own data. It replaces the panel's proposal to rewrite the fund's rules, which the verifier found had nothing left to rewrite.

8. Help eligible households, above all pensioners, get Wohngeld applications in by 31 December

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bezirksamt Wohngeldstelle, with social counsellors and neighbourhood centres	31 December 2026	staff time; not costed	a cut in housing support landing in the coldest months

The federal cabinet's draft of 6 July 2026 would halve Wohngeld's heating component (from €96 to €48 for one person, though the payment falls by less than €48), skip the 2027 increase, and end eligibility for between 238,000 and 500,000 households nationally, depending on the estimate. It has had its first reading, needs the Bundesrat's consent, and is meant to apply from 1 January 2027. Under the draft, applications received by 31 December 2026 keep the current amount for their approval period. Wohngeld is cash, which suits a shock driven by heating bills.

Transferability: national law, local delivery. The bill could change before it passes; the advice is to apply early either way.

9. Before July 2027, secure a new site for Frauentreff Olga on Kurfürstenstraße, or agree where its contact work moves

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
SenASGIVA, with Bezirksamt Mitte and Bezirksamt Tempelhof-Schöneberg	agreed by 31 March 2027; lease ends July 2027	not costed; rent depends on the site	the street scene losing its trusted contact point just as summer heat arrives

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Olga, at Kurfürstenstraße 40 on the Tiergarten side of the street, has given food, clothing, and harm-reduction supplies to women in street sex work and drug use since 1987. It is run by Notdienst für Suchtmittelgefährdete und -abhängige Berlin e.V., and the Senate already funds its work. The taz reported in June 2026 that its lease ends in July 2027 and the space is to become a café; a petition passed 2,500 signatures. The people around Kurfürstenstraße and Bülowstraße take a phone number from an Olga worker before they take one from an official.

Evidence: none on outcomes. No study shows that trusted contact points improve heat or cold reach for this group; the case rests on SenASGIVA's own description of the Hitzehilfe as a central contact point for the same people. No Bezirk or Senate response to the lease end was found.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	Bezirksamt Tempelhof-Schöneberg	SenASGIVA	Senate Interior (disaster law)	Care services and trainers	Nachbarschaftsheim and neighbourhood groups	Kältehilfe and street-work providers	Verbraucherzentrale Berlin	Bezirksamt Mitte
1. Consent-based list	**A/R**	**I**	**C**	**R**	**C**			
2. Kältehilfe surge	**C**	**A**			**I**	**R**		
3. Heat-warning calls and visits	**A**			**C**	**R**			
4. Cool rooms and Hitzehilfe	**A/R**	**R**			**R**	**R**		
5. Blackout help points	**A/R**		**C**		**R**	**I**		
6. Care-service heat training	**A**			**R**				
7. Cut-off advice	**A**	**I**			**R**		**R**	
8. Wohngeld applications	**A/R**				**R**			
9. Olga's contact point	**C**	**A**				**R**		**R**

What the chart shows: the Bezirksamt Tempelhof-Schöneberg is accountable for seven of the nine actions, and the neighbourhood groups do the work in five. Rows 1, 5, 7, 8, and 9 need decisions and staff time, not new money. The Senate's social department is accountable for the two that serve homeless people.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. No placement here has a published cost per life saved in a setting like Schöneberg, so the order is a judgement of how directly each reaches the people most at risk. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before summer 2027, not by what it needs.

FLOOR
€58,000 (US$65,053)

TARGET
€90,400 (US$101,393)

CEILING
€115,400 (US$129,433)

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
How many people would consent to the list, and how hot summer 2027 is; neither is forecast

Floor: heat-warning calls and visits (€25,000) plus care-service training (€33,000), €58,000 in all. Target: the floor plus staff for two more cool rooms (€32,400), €90,400. Ceiling: the target plus Kältebus operations (€20,000) and the blackout leaflets and card (€5,000), €115,400. Above that, the district's groups cannot spend more well before June. The panel proposed €185,400 as the target. It fell by 51% because a €75,000 (US$84,120) heat-coordinator salary was removed: it is a civil-service post that donors cannot fill. The panel's figure of about €84,000

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

per death averted was also retracted, because it credited this money with the effect of having a heat plan at all (1.8 deaths per 100,000 a year across Europe; Urban 2025), which Berlin already has. Public money that is not part of the envelope: the Kältehilfe surge (€90,000, SenASGIVA) and the Hitzehilfe (€85,412, already budgeted).

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Nachbarschaftsheim Schöneberg	Action 3: calls and doorstep visits on heat-warning days	€25,000 (US$28,040)	direct grant	An estimate for a part-time organiser and volunteer training; Philadelphia's warning system, about €187,000 (US$210,000) and an estimated 117 lives over 1995–98 (Ebi 2004), as an analogue. Must add visits, not duplicate Silbernetz's heat calls	Partially confirmed
Bär meets Adler e.V., through the district QPK	Action 6: heat training for about 55 care services	€33,000 (US$37,013)	direct grant	An estimate at €600 a service; no published price, and no evidence on deaths	Partially confirmed
Nachbarschaftsheim Schöneberg and other cool-room hosts	Action 4: staff for two more cool rooms	€32,400 (US$36,340)	direct grant	90 days × 6 hours × 2 rooms × €30 an hour, an estimate; cool places OR 0.34 (Bouchama 2007)	Partially confirmed
Berliner Stadtmission Kältebus	Action 2: frost-night outreach	€20,000 (US$22,432)	direct grant	No quote obtained; the buses run entirely on donations, and three were burned in December 2025 and January 2026. No cost-effectiveness figure exists	Partially confirmed
Bezirksamt Tempelhof-Schöneberg	Action 5: blackout leaflets and multilingual card	€5,000 (US$5,608)	direct grant	An estimate	Partially confirmed

The funder's one thing: the district wrote a heat plan, and then the €100,000 a year that paid for it ended. The cheapest life saved here is a knock on the door of someone bedridden under the roof on a hot afternoon, and nobody is currently paid to make it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for these hazards and would cost lives here.

Do not tell an older person that a fan will keep them safe *

CONTRAINDICATED CORRECTED

In a 2024 randomised trial (O'Connor and colleagues, JAMA), 18 adults aged 65–85 spent eight hours at 36 °C and 45% humidity: a fan did not lower their peak body temperature. A 2024 review in The Lancet Planetary Health advises against fans above 35 °C for people over 65.

Instead: on heat-warning days, move them out of the top-floor room, use cool showers and wet skin, take them to a cool room, and check on them in person.

Do not plan this winter around an "El Niño cold winter," and do not wait for one

CONTRAINDICATED CORRECTED

Strong El Niños have sometimes come before cold late winters in Central Europe (1940–42), but the link is weak, runs through the stratosphere, and has faded since the 1970s. The last strong El Niño winter, 2023/24, was Germany's third mildest on record, at 4.1 °C, while January 2026 brought −15 °C with no El Niño at all. Telling people a harsh El Niño winter is coming would be wrong; waiting for one before preparing would be worse.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: plan for an ordinary Berlin winter with cold snaps: full Kältehilfe capacity all season, with surges on occupancy and DWD frost warnings (action 2).

Do not count cool rooms and flyers as protection for the people most at risk

CONTRAINDICATED CORRECTED

The district's 2026 heat plan is mostly communication: flyers, drinking tips, and cool rooms. In the French 2003 study of older people who died at home, being confined to bed or a chair multiplied the odds of death 9.6-fold, and a bedroom under the roof 4.1-fold. Those people cannot walk to a church hall. Cool rooms help the people who can reach them; they do not reach the bedridden.

Instead: spend first on contact with bedridden people and those who sleep under the roof (actions 1 and 3), and offer escorts to the cool rooms.

Do not offer people sleeping rough only dormitory beds

CONTRAINDICATED CORRECTED

In a Berlin focus-group study the Senate reported to parliament, users named theft of belongings and no access for animals among their reasons for avoiding shelters (the Senate calls the data low-validity). A shelter bed someone refuses saves no one on a frost night.

Instead: some surge places with lockers and rooms for dogs and couples, and Kältebus outreach to people who will not come in (action 2).

In a blackout, do not rely only on loudspeaker announcements and emergency shelters

CONTRAINDICATED CONFIRMED

In the January 2026 blackout next door, the district's review found that police loudspeaker announcements "proved ineffective," and emergency shelters were 10–15% full at night (Rathaus Zehlendorf about 35%), though people used them heavily by day as warm contact points. The review also says opening shelters is always necessary.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: open the shelters, and also announce the help points in advance (action 5) and go to the people on the list (action 1).

Do not send anyone to Berlin's Härtefallfonds Energieschulden

CONTRAINDICATED CONFIRMED

Berlin's hardship fund for energy debts stopped taking applications on 31 December 2025. In its last year it approved 2 of 195 applications and paid €945 (US$1,060) in total, and people on Bürgergeld or social assistance had been excluded since January 2024. Some advice lists still mention it.

Instead: the Verbraucherzentrale's free energy-debt advice (030 21485-202) and a Jobcenter or Sozialamt loan (action 7).

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1940–42	Three severe Central European winters during a long El Niño	No Berlin figure	Later research linked them to El Niño (Brönnimann 2004); the link has since weakened
1946–47	"Hunger winter" in post-war Berlin	1,142 Berliners frozen or starved, as counted by the city's social affairs councillor (secondary source)	Not recorded
1994	Summer heat	877 heat deaths in Berlin, the highest on record	Nothing that the record shows
2003	European heatwave	0 heat deaths in Berlin; about 15,000 in France	France built registers of vulnerable people; Berlin had no shock to force reform
2006, 2010	Summer heat	233 and 386 heat deaths	Nothing that the record shows

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2010	January cold, during an El Niño winter	At least 14 homeless people dead of cold across Germany by 25 January	Not recorded
2017	Cloudburst, 29 June: 196.9 mm at Tegel in a day, a record	No death toll found	Berlin set a target to disconnect rainwater from the sewers, which parliament later recorded as clearly missed
2018, 2019	Summer heat	398 and 186 heat deaths	Nothing that the record shows
2019	Köpenick blackout, 19–20 February, about 31 hours	About 31,000 households and 2,000 businesses without power; critical patients moved	Not recorded
2022	Summer heat	425 heat deaths	Hitzeaktionsplan process began in 2024; adopted by the Senate on 25 November 2025
2023–25	Summer heat	110, 52, and 26 heat deaths (2025 provisional); the 1985–2025 average is 97	District heat grants of €100,000 a year in 2024 and 2025, then ended
2025	Johannisthal arson blackout, 9 September, about 60 hours	About 50,000 customers without power, including two care homes	Not recorded
2026	South-west Berlin arson blackout, 3–7 January, in frost; Kältebus fleet burned	45,400 households and 2,200 businesses without power or heating for about 4.5 days	State disaster law amended: a voluntary emergency register (§ 5a), in force 23 July 2026
2026	January frost, down to −15 °C	Kältehilfe places raised to 1,280; occupancy peaked at about 96%	Kältehilfe 2026/27 planned at about 1,000 places

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2026	Summer heat	58 extra heat deaths in Berlin, June–September (tracker)	Not yet known

The recurrence nobody has noticed: Berlin plans for heat as if 2003 were its warning, but 2003 barely touched it. Its own worst summer was 1994, and its deaths swing fifteen-fold between years. The same pattern holds in winter: in January 2026 the people most at risk were found neither in the heat plan nor in the blackout plan, because nobody kept a list of them.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE

UNRESOLVED

- **Strong El Niños freeze Berlin** versus **the link has nearly vanished**. The Historian cited the winters of 1940–42 and 2009/10 and urged pre-funding late-winter cold capacity; the Skeptic cited research showing the teleconnection weakened after the 1970s. The verifier found both sets of papers real and sided with the Skeptic on what to say. The action is the same either way: prepare for an ordinary winter with cold snaps. Official seasonal outlooks for December–February could not be read for this briefing; re-check Copernicus around 10 November.
- **Cool rooms save lives** versus **the people at risk cannot reach them**. The Public Health lens ranked cool rooms high (OR 0.34); the Skeptic said nobody measures who uses them. Both are kept: rooms with escorts (action 4), but contact first (action 3).
- **Portable air conditioners**. No lens found Berlin evidence on their effect on bills or the grid, in either direction. The briefing leaves them as a household choice and does not fund them.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED

BLIND SPOT

The list in action 1 is built through care services, so it cannot see very old people who live alone with no care service, no relatives nearby, and no GP visits, who are the people most likely to be found too late. Nobody has counted how many people over 85 live alone in Schöneberg; the 2,760 figure is from the neighbouring district's blackout area. No lens covered outdoor workers and delivery riders in summer heat, or people without registered residence, who appear on no list.

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HOW TO READ THIS METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are published at state level, here the whole of Berlin. They are not Schöneberg figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only* and ends in March 2027; cold, blackouts, cloudbursts, and summer 2027 are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The location was taken as given: Schöneberg, the Ortsteil in Bezirk Tempelhof-Schöneberg, Berlin, including Schöneberg-Nord around Nollendorfplatz, Bülowstraße, and Kurfürstenstraße. This briefing was requested directly, not through the elninoready.earth form. Mortality figures exist only at state level; much of the district data (the heat plan, the care-service count, the cool rooms) covers the whole Bezirk of about 350,000 people. Local detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, file `v261026_adm1_output_BASE_rounded_cust.csv` (version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review): Berlin (GADM DEU.3_1), 58 additional heat deaths June–September 2026 (June 44, July 2, August 10, September 3; the months sum to 59 because of rounding), 2 forecast October 2026 – March 2027 (October 2, every other month 0), 60 in total; Germany, 2,500, of which 31 are forecast from October; the world, 857,400. This update supersedes the September report *451,000 at Risk*. Method: ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts applied to temperature–mortality relationships against a 1996–2025 baseline. The figures count heat only; we inferred this from the data, because cold countries show exactly zero in every winter month. They are never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections. The official Berlin heat-death counts in the record come from the Amt für Statistik Berlin-Brandenburg and use a different method.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. Because the tracker's deaths had already happened, the lenses were asked to plan for this winter and for summer 2027.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by

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dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked as needing staff time only, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.

- **Verification.** Eight verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the deadline, including under German data-protection law). Financial actions were also checked for availability in Berlin, a named payer, a trigger, and whether they already exist; one, the energy-debt fund, turned out to have closed. Food actions were checked for published price series and timing. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed. The resident steps and every phone number were checked against primary pages, and every event in the record against its source.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Could not be consulted: the inventory loads its entries in the browser and returned none to the research agents. No action is tagged with a precedent from it.
- **Money.** Costs are shown in euros with US dollars in parentheses, at €1 = US$1.1216 (ECB reference rate, 2 November 2026).
- **Reader.** No role was given, so the For you section is written for a resident. Its steps were taken from the verified actions and from what the panel found about households here; steps not drawn from a ranked action were verified on the same three tests. The rest of the report is written for the district, the Senate, and their partners.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (cooling older people, fans, medicines, medical equipment in a blackout, emergency supplies, and when to call 112) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, or nurse first.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number. Estimates are labelled as estimates. The Kältehilfe surge cost multiplies the Senate's own published average cost per place by a number of places and nights. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in Schöneberg was interviewed. The December–February seasonal outlook could not be read. The Ortsteil's population, its number of people over 85 living

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alone, and the Hauptausschuss's decision on the Hitzehilfe money could not be confirmed. Two lenses gave different Berlin heat-death counts for 2022 and 2023; the statistics office's figures are used. The federal Wohngeld bill had not passed when this was written. One Senate answer on 2026–27 district heat money was read only through a search summary.

References · Climate Impact Lab, El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data v261026 (downloaded 30 Oct 2026); tracker · confirmed
Bezirksamt Tempelhof-Schöneberg, Hitzeschutzplan 2026 · confirmed; district cool rooms · confirmed; Katastrophenschutz-Leuchttürme · confirmed; Berlin help points · confirmed; Senate, Hitzeaktionsplan adopted · confirmed
Bezirksamt Steglitz-Zehlendorf, review of the January 2026 blackout · confirmed; § 5a KatSG, GVBl. 22 Jul 2026 · confirmed; Senate answers S19-25581 (no registration of electricity-dependent people), S19-25056 · confirmed; Stromnetz Berlin, January 2026 and September 2025 · confirmed; Köpenick 2019, Tagesspiegel · confirmed (press)
Kältehilfe: berlin.de/kaeltehilfe · confirmed; SenASGIVA, 2025/26 season and 9 Jan 2026 · confirmed; Senate answers S19-25806 (Schöneberg sites), S19-25510 (January occupancy), S19-17421 (reasons for avoiding shelters) · confirmed; S19-22334 (cost per place) · confirmed by verifier; 2026/27 capacity, Berlin Echo · confirmed (secondary); Kältebus arson, evangelisch.de · confirmed; Kältebus funding, Berliner Zeitung · confirmed (press); street count 2020, Ärzteblatt · confirmed; Zhang et al., IJERPH 2019 · confirmed
Hitzehilfe, SenASGIVA to the Hauptausschuss, Vorlage 2867, 13 May 2026 · confirmed (release not confirmed); Olga, taz, 17 Jun 2026, Bezirksamt Mitte, Senate answer S19-16748 · confirmed
Bouchama et al., Arch Intern Med 2007 · confirmed; Liotta et al., IJERPH 2018 · confirmed (observational); Bretin, Vandentorren et al., InVS 2003 at-home study · confirmed; Ebi et al., BAMS 2004 · confirmed; Urban et al. 2025, Environ Res Lett 20:124071 · confirmed; O'Connor et al., JAMA 2024;332(20):1752 · confirmed; Meade et al., Lancet Planet Health 2024 · confirmed; ABDA, heat-relevant medicines · confirmed
Nachbarschaftsheim Schöneberg, annual report 2025 · confirmed; Silbernetz, silbernetz.org · confirmed; heat-warning calls, berlin.de, 21 Aug 2026 · confirmed (coverage of Schöneberg not confirmed); DWD heat warnings, newsletter · confirmed; BBK, Ratgeber Notfallvorsorge · confirmed
Energy debt: Senate answer S19-24809 · confirmed; Verbraucherzentrale Berlin, Energieschuldenberatung · confirmed; § 41f EnWG · confirmed. Prices: Destatis PD26 382 and PD26 364 · confirmed. Wohngeld: Mieterbund, 8 Oct 2026, transition rule · confirmed (secondary; bill not passed); processing times, S19-25882 · confirmed
Record: Amt für Statistik Berlin-Brandenburg, heat deaths · confirmed; 1946/47, Berliner Kurier · confirmed (secondary only); 2010 cold, evangelisch.de · confirmed; 2017 cloudburst, DKKV · confirmed; rainwater target, Drucksache 19/0671 · reported by lens; Berliner Wasserbetriebe, Rückstausicherung · confirmed
El Niño and European winters: Brönnimann et al., Nature 2004; Ineson & Scaife, Nat Geosci 2009; Ivasić, Herceg-Bulić & King, Clim Dyn 2021; DWD, winter 2023/24 · confirmed
Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk (superseded) · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 2 November 2026 for Schöneberg, Berlin. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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